Arab Iron & Steel Union

General Assembly

Board meeting no. 104, Manama, Kingdom of Bahrain

14-15 May 2012 @ the Kempenski Hotel

Monday May 14, 2012

The delegates and guests arrived to Bahrain and a dinner reception was hosted by SULB at the Ritz Carlton Gazebo. The dinner included a welcome speech by Mr. Khalid Al Qaderi (CEO of Fulath) and a speech by the Minister of Industry and Commerce, Dr. Hassan Fakhro. This was followed by a presentation introducing the company of Foulath by Dr. Khalid Al Qaderi. Some questions were followed by the local media and press.

Tuesday May 15, 2012

The delegates of the Arab Iron & Steel Union met at the Kempenski Meeting rooms at 9am. After some networking and breakfast, the secretary general and the president convened the 104th meeting. The President of the Arab Iron & Steel Union, Dr. Hilal Altuwaqeri welcomed the member to the Kingdom of Bahrain thanking them for their attendance and their cooperation during these difficult times in the Arab region.

Conditions of the Arab World

Dr. Altuwaqeri began the meeting by introducing the delegates and asked the delegates to give a brief of the latest progress in their plants and regions. Dr. Altuwaqeri specifically asked the delegates of Egypt, Libya and Syria to explain the current socioeconomic conditions in their factories and countries. The delegates of Egypt, including Egypt Iron & Steel Company, Ezz Steel indicated that situation in Egypt is improving and workers are going back to work. They were positive overall, and looked forward to the outcome of the presidential elections on May 23-24.

On the other hand, the delegates of Syria including Joud Steel and the General Association of Arab Manufactures, indicated that most of the factories remain closed in Syria due to power failure and shortage. Some factories work at night on an irregular basis for safety reasons. The Syrian delegates were explained that the situation in Syria is discouraging.

Finally, the member of Libyan Iron & Steel Company gave the latest progress on the developing changes in Libya. The factory is located in the city of Missratah and has been shut down from February 011 until December 2011. The factory had been bombed frequently, but adter the political reform in the country, the factory has recommenced operations in February 2012.

Chairman then indicated that aid to the factories in devastated areas must first come from the country itself, then the Arab neighbors, and finally from the foreigners. He had explained that these are extraordinary times, and the Arabs need to work together to get back to work.

Mr. Khalid AlQaderi of Foulath had indicated that the two new Foulath Projects in Egpyt will be put on hold until the situation in Egypt stabilizes. These two factories will produce 1 million tons of iron & steel.

The delegates of the Gulf States indicated that there are expansions in the region particularly in Bahrain, UAE, Qatar, and Saudi Arabia.

Agenda & Business Matters

The Secretary General then introduced Business Matters from the agenda. A Summary of the following agenda includes:

- Attestation of previous minutes of meeting no 103 held in Abu Dhabi December 2011
- Discussion over the Board Resolution no (6) of Abu Dhabi meeting no. 103 regarding to membership in the Arab Union of Steel & Iron. Ezz Steel and SABIC were to form a committee to study the regulations of the Union to ensure that payments and memberships are paid on time. Many members feel that they are not benefiting from their membership and have therefore decided to withdraw their membership. These delegates include Ferrovial of Algeria, Greif Company of Morocco. The committee failed to meet from December 2011 – May 2012. Therefore, it was suggested by Mr. Khaled AlQaderi to post suggestions for maintaining membership fees and modifying the legislature of the Union via email rather than formal committee meetings.
- Discussion over the letter received from Ambassoder Mohamed Mohamed Rabee, Secretary General of the League f Arab States, Coucil of Economic Unity. The letter discussed the certain clauses and resolutions amongst the Arab Steel & Iron Union which differ from those of the League of Arab States, Council of Economic Union. The chairman and General Secretary of Arab Steel & Iron Union decided to give the General Assembly and Member 21 days to review the clauses and give their feedback. If the members or General Assembly do not have any comments, then the document will be accepted and ratified into the Arab Iron and Steel Union's structure.
- It was decided the next meeting will be held in Tunis, Tunisia in November 2012. More details with regards to venue, sponsorship, etc to follow.

Visit to SULB Factory

Meeting closed at 2:00pm followed by Lunch hosted by Gulf Industrial Investment Comnpany GIIC at the Kempenski Hotel. The delegates were then invited to SULB factory in Hidd Industrial area to visit the newly built facilities which were impressive.